

October

17

Empress of China

690

China's only female ruler, Empress Wu Zetian was the power behind the throne of both her husband and her son until she took control in her own right. Her reign was marked by economic success and the expansion of China's empire.



Born this day

1914 Jerry Siegel, US comic book writer. Along with comic book artist Joe Schuster, he created the world-famous character Superman.

2008

Snack attack

A hungry crowd in Tehran, Iran, foiled a record-breaking attempt to make the world's longest sandwich, taking bites before judges could measure it.

2014

Climate warriors

To raise awareness of the dangers of fossil fuels, protestors from 12 low-lying Pacific island nations threatened by rising sea levels sailed into Australia's Newcastle Coal Port in canoes and blocked coal ships from leaving.



Also on this day

1604 German astronomer Johannes Kepler observed SN 1604, the last supernova (exploding star) in our galaxy to be seen without a telescope.

1931 After a lifetime of crime, US gangster Al Capone was imprisoned for 11 years. He had been charged with failing to pay his taxes.

2009 British footballer Darren Bent scored a win for his team when his shot hit a beach ball thrown onto the pitch by fans and bounced straight into the net.

